Chapter 21

Introduction

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Figure 1: *Hua gunaha* – Paddling ashore

Apart from one modern kind of metal boat, I only observed dug-out canoes with outriggers in the Teop area during my fieldwork trips between 2000 and 2014. There are two kinds of dug-out outrigger canoes: the indigenous outrigger canoe called *sinivi suuna* and the *potee*, a new type of outrigger canoe that is said to originate from the Solomon Islands. Both kinds of canoe are dugouts built from a single log, but differ in the width of the hull and the construction of the outrigger.

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Figure 2: *Sinivi suuna* – Indigenous canoe



Figure 3: *Potee* – A new type of canoe

The first text by Mark Tahi and Enoch Horai Magum describes the hull of the *sinivi suuna* and is followed by Ruth Sima Rigamu's description of the outrigger float, which is an excerpt from her texts about trees. The tree in question is called *kopihoo*. As we could not identify its scientific or its English name, we included two photographs of this tree. In third chapter Paul Morekevan and Enoch Horai Magum describe the hull and the outrigger of the *potee* canoe. The word *sinivi* is a generic term for both types of canoe, and the name for the Blackboard Tree, see Chapter 7, which is used for building the hull of these canoes.

The construction of the Teop *sinivi suuna* is similar to the outrigger dug-out canoes on Petats, an island off the west coast of Buka, and in Kurtatchi, a village on the north coast of Bougainville that have been described by Blackwood (1935: 360-381). Her list of "terms used in connection with dug-out canoe" shows several terms of the Kurtachi language that are closely related to the corresponding Teop terms, see Table 1 and Blackwood (1935: 367). According to the people Blackwood (1935: 360) and Shoffner (1976: 186) worked with, the outrigger dugout canoe was

Table 1: Similar Kurtatchi and Teop terms related to the dugout outrigger canoe

MEANING OF TERM	KURTATCHI	TEOP
Dug-out canoe with outrigger	*tʃinív*	*sinivi*
Tree of which it is generally made	*tʃinív*	*sinivi*
Outrigger booms and pole forming platform	*wanér*	*vanai*
Outrigger float	*ag* or *waga*	*aga*

introduced to North-Bougainville before European contact. In contrast to other people of Bougainville, the Teop people did not build plank canoes (Blackwood 1935: 370, Shoffner 1976: 186).

The *potee* canoe, see Figure 3, is not regarded as a *sinivi suuna* 'indigenous canoe', but said to be a type of canoe from the Solomon Islands to which the Teop people attached an outrigger with two booms, see Chapter 24:47ff. The terms used for the parts of the *potee* and the process of its building are the same as for the *sinivi suuna*. When I stayed at Hiovabon for my last fieldwork in 2014, most people used the *sinivi suuna*.



Figure 4: Teop Harbour in 2013

The two texts about the *sinivi suuna* and the *potee* do not mention which kinds of wood are used to make the hull and the outriggers, but Joyce Maion describes in Chapter 7 the *sinivi* 'Blackboard Tree (*Alstonia scholaris*)' and mentions two

further trees: the *maramakasi* which we did not identify and the *bio* a kind of Ficus tree. Other trees for canoe building are:

- *Marakaoto* 'tree species (*Terminalia species*)' – https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-marakaoto
- *Tako* 'Alexandrian Laurel (*Callophyllum mophyllum*)' – https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-tako_1
- *Voata* 'tree species (*Euodia elleryana*)' – https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-voata